ACDRM
AFRICAN CENTRE FOR DISASTER RISK MANAGEMENT
STRENGTHENING SYSTEMS. BUILDING RESILIENCE.

CALL FOR CHAPTERS

From Response to Resilience:

Reform, Anticipation and Inclusion in Disaster Governance

Nigeria's Institutional Transformation and Africa's Future Horizons

EDITED VOLUME

Issued by the African Centre for Disaster Risk Management (ACDRM), Abuja, Nigeria. An edited volume on proactive disaster governance, inviting practitioner, policy and scholarly contributions. Items in [square brackets] are to be confirmed before release.

Call for Chapters

From Response to Resilience: Reform, Anticipation and Inclusion in Disaster Governance — Nigeria's Institutional Transformation and Africa's Future Horizons

1. ABOUT THE VOLUME

Disaster management in Nigeria is changing. For decades the dominant model was relief after the event: assess the damage, mobilise resources, distribute assistance. In recent years the emphasis has shifted towards governing risk before the hazard arrives, through early warning and early action, stronger coordination across tiers of government, inclusive planning, and sustained investment in prevention.

This edited volume documents, analyses and critically evaluates that shift. It treats Nigeria's experience as a case from which the wider African continent can learn, and it honours the leadership, institutions and frontline responders who have driven reform, including the strategic direction set under the Director General of the National Emergency Management Agency (NEMA), Mrs. Zubaida Umar.

The volume is organised around a single idea, *the anticipatory state*, built on five mutually reinforcing moves: *Shift*, *Anticipate*, *Align*, *Include* and *Sustain*. Its argument is that reform fails when any one move is missing: forecasts without local action are noise, coordination without funding is paper, and technology without public trust does not reach people.

Convening organisation: African Centre for Disaster Risk Management (ACDRM), a pan-African centre headquartered in Abuja, Nigeria. Lead editor: Dr. Emenike John Umesi, Founding Director, ACDRM. Co-editor: [independent academic co-editor, to be confirmed]. Publisher: [to be confirmed].

2. AIMS OF THE VOLUME

- Provide an evidence-based account of Nigeria's move from reactive relief to proactive risk governance.
- Capture practitioner knowledge that is rarely published, including operational lessons from early warning, trigger-based action, coordination and recovery.
- Test what has worked, what has not, and why, using data, case evidence and comparison with other African and global experience.
- Place inclusion, dignity and accountability at the centre of disaster policy, alongside technology and institutions.
- Offer a practical agenda for 2027–2030 and the period after the Sendai Framework.

3. INVITED CONTRIBUTIONS BY PART

We invite chapter proposals under any of the eighteen themes below. Each theme is described by its core question; proposals may refine or sharpen the question, but should stay within the part's focus. Proposals on closely related topics will be considered where they strengthen a part.

Part I. SHIFT: Changing the Mandate

From relief agency to risk governor.

Theme 1. From Relief to Risk Governance. How has Nigeria's emergency architecture evolved, why did relief dominate for so long, and what broke the pattern?

Theme 2. Strategy, Law and Policy. How do the National Disaster Risk Reduction Strategy and Action Plan 2025–2030, the review of the National Disaster Management Framework and the legal framework define the mandate, and where do law and practice diverge?

Theme 3. Leadership and Institutional Change. How does reform happen inside a public agency? Contributions may examine vision, change management, organisational culture, political support and the sustainability of reform beyond one leadership term.

Part II. ANTICIPATE: Science, Data and Early Action

From forecast to local action.

Theme 4. Early Warning and Early Action. How do national operations centres, including the National Emergency Operations Centre, turn monitoring into decisions, and what links warning to action?

Theme 5. Fusion and Trigger Approaches. How are meteorological, hydrological and satellite data fused into triggers that start pre-agreed actions in vulnerable communities?

Theme 6. Space-Based Intervention and Technical Alliances. What has geospatial and satellite technology, and international training partnership, added to local capability, and is the gain sustained?

Theme 7. The Last Mile. Why do warnings fail to reach or move people, and how can language, trust, media, radio, mobile alerts and traditional leaders close the gap?

Part III. ALIGN: Collaborative Governance and Capability

From many agencies to one system.

Theme 8. Federal, State and Local Cohesion. How can operating standards be harmonised across tiers of government, including through the National Forum of State Emergency Management Agencies, and what is the role of local government?

Theme 9. Coordination in Insecure and Complex Settings. How do incident command, civil–military coordination and humanitarian response work in conflict-affected areas, displacement and compound emergencies?

Theme 10. Partnerships and Localisation. How can development partners, civil society, universities and the private sector support national ownership without creating parallel systems?

Theme 11. Workforce, Training and Professionalisation. What career structures, competency frameworks, academies and certification are needed to build a professional emergency management workforce?

Part IV. INCLUDE: People, Dignity and Accountability

From affected populations to partners.

Theme 12. Gender-Sensitive Disaster Management. How are the health, protection, security and livelihood needs of women and girls built into risk planning and response, and how is women's leadership supported?

Theme 13. Beyond Gender. How can planning and relief reach children, older people, persons with disabilities and displaced people, including through community-led vulnerability mapping?

Theme 14. Dignity and Accountability in Crisis. What does ethical, empathetic and transparent delivery require of public servants, and how do complaint and feedback mechanisms work in practice?

Part V. SUSTAIN: Finance, Evidence and Horizons

From achievement to permanence.

Theme 15. Financing Resilience. How can budgets move from relief to risk investment through contingency and anticipatory financing, state counterpart funding, risk transfer and value-for-money evidence?

Theme 16. Flood Management Case Study. What do successive flood seasons show about warning, preparedness, response and recovery? Empirical, comparative case contributions are especially welcome.

Theme 17. Monitoring, Evaluation and Learning. Which indicators and after-action review methods show whether anticipation, coordination and inclusion are improving?

Theme 18. Africa's Horizon. What should Nigeria contribute to, and learn from, regional cooperation, cross-border early warning and the post-2030 disaster risk agenda?

4. WHO SHOULD RESPOND

We welcome proposals from:

- Disaster risk reduction and emergency management practitioners in federal, state and local agencies;
- Academics and researchers in disaster studies, public administration, climate science, geography, gender studies, health, law and related fields;
- Representatives of United Nations agencies, development partners, civil society and humanitarian organisations;
- Private sector, media and technology practitioners working on risk information and communication.

Co-authored chapters pairing a practitioner with an academic are encouraged. Early-career researchers and women authors are especially welcome.

5. TYPES OF CONTRIBUTION

Table 1: Types of Contribution

Type	Length	Description
Full chapter	5,000–6,500 words	Analytical chapter following the volume template
Case study chapter	4,000–5,000 words	Focused, evidence-rich account of one event, programme or institution
Practitioner note	1,500–2,000 words	Short reflective piece from the field, published as a boxed insight within a part

6. THE CHAPTER TEMPLATE

To keep the volume coherent, every chapter follows six movements:

1. **Question:** the policy or practice problem.
2. **Nigerian baseline:** what the system looked like before reform.
3. **Reform and evidence:** what changed, supported by data and one boxed case.
4. **African and global comparison:** one or two comparators.

5. **Lessons and risks:** what transfers and what does not.
6. **Horizon:** three recommendations for 2027–2030.

Each chapter closes with a *Practitioner Takeaways* box of five bullet points and three discussion questions suitable for training use.

7. HOW TO SUBMIT

Send a single Word document or PDF containing the following to emenike.umesi@acdrm.org, with the subject line *"Call for Chapters – [Surname] – [Theme number]"*:

- Chapter title and the theme number it responds to;
- An abstract of 400–500 words stating the question, evidence and method, and the main argument;
- Five keywords;
- The types of data or sources to be used, with confirmation that primary documents will be cited;
- A biography of each author (up to 150 words), with institutional affiliation and contact details;
- A statement of any interest or affiliation with ACDRM, NEMA or other organisations discussed in the chapter.

8. TIMELINE

Table 2: Timeline

Stage	Date
Call released	October 15, 2026
Abstract deadline	November 15, 2026
Notification of acceptance	November 30, 2026
Author workshop	December 8, 2026
Full chapter deadline	March 30, 2027
Peer review and fact-check	March – June 2027
Revised chapters due	August 31, 2027
Production and launch	December 2027

9. REVIEW, STANDARDS AND ETHICS

- **Peer review:** every chapter is reviewed double-blind by two reviewers, one from academia and one with practitioner experience.
- **Fact-check:** statements about the operations of NEMA and other agencies are checked against primary documents, so authors must cite official sources (reports, releases, strategies, legislation) and not rely on secondary summaries.
- **Originality:** work must be original, unpublished and not under consideration elsewhere. All submissions are screened for similarity.

- **Use of AI tools:** any use of generative AI in preparing a chapter must be disclosed. Authors remain responsible for the accuracy of all content and citations.
- **Independence and disclosure:** authors must declare any role in, or funding from, the institutions they write about. The volume is edited with external review to protect scholarly independence.
- **Research ethics:** chapters involving human participants must state ethical approval or consent arrangements. Authors must protect affected communities and avoid identifying individuals without consent.
- **Style:** APA 7th edition referencing, British English spelling, 12-point font, double spacing for full drafts.
- **Rights and fees:** No submission or publication fee; copyright and licensing terms to be confirmed with the publisher.

10. CONTACT

Editorial Office, African Centre for Disaster Risk Management (ACDRM), Abuja, Nigeria. Email: emenike.umesi@acdrm.org. Website: www.acdrm.org. Please direct questions about themes, formats and deadlines to the editorial office before submitting.

Issued by the African Centre for Disaster Risk Management (ACDRM). Dr. Emenike John Umesi, Lead Editor, on behalf of the editorial team.